

Internship Report

Title: Two-Month Internship Report at Child Rights and You (CRY)

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Course: MA HUMAN RIGHTS AND DUTIES

Internship Duration: [10 JUNE – 10 AUG]

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1. Introduction

This report outlines my two-month internship experience with **Child Rights and You (CRY)**, a leading **non-governmental organization** (Ngo) founded in 1979, works to ensure happy, healthy, and creative childhoods for underprivileged children in India. CRY focuses on four key areas: education, health and nutrition, child protection, and child participation. My primary motivation for joining CRY was to gain practical exposure to the realities of child rights work, understand grassroots-level interventions, and contribute meaningfully to the protection, development, and empowerment of children in vulnerable situations. My internship mainly focused on field engagement, community building, research, and direct child support work in **North Delhi district**.

2. Objectives of the Internship

The key objectives of my internship were:

- Strengthen my understanding of child rights issues at the community level.
- To engage directly with communities to build awareness and participation in child rights.
- To assist in field-level interventions for the welfare and protection of children.
- Contribute to CRY's ongoing work in education, child protection, and rehabilitation.
- Gain hands-on experience in data collection, documentation, and legal tools such as RTI.
- Engage directly with vulnerable children and communities to support their development and well-being.

3. Internship Activities

Week 1–2: Orientation and Initial Field Engagement

- Attended orientation sessions to understand SHAKSHAM vision, mission, and ongoing projects.
- Accompanied with the field volunteers to shahbad dairy and mahaveer chowk area of **North Delhi district** to learn about existing challenges faced by children.

- Initiated rapport-building with community members to understand socio-economic conditions.

Week 3–4: Community Building and Teaching

- Conducted interactive sessions with children to encourage participation in education.
- Assisted in teaching basic subjects like English, maths, and translations to the children who were school dropouts or irregular in attendance.
- Organized informal activities to promote positive learning environments.

Week 5–6: RTI Filing for Missing Children

- Researched and documented data related to missing children cases in **North Delhi district**.
- Drafted and filed **Right to Information (RTI) applications** with relevant police stations to obtain updates on missing child cases.

Week 7-8: Intervention with Children Involved in Substance Abuse

- Worked with community outreach workers to identify and engage with children involved in drug use.
- Facilitated awareness sessions on the harmful effects of substance abuse.
- Connected vulnerable children with rehabilitation support services and counseling resources.
- Compiled field data.
- Participated in review meetings to share insights from field work.

4. Skills and Learning

Through this internship, I developed:

- **Field Research Skills:** Understanding community dynamics, data collection, and structured observation.
- **Advocacy Tools:** Learning the RTI process for accessing government records, case documentation, community survey methods.
- **Communication & Teaching Skills:** Community rapport-building, educational activities and interacting with diverse stakeholders
- **Empathy & Sensitivity:** Working with vulnerable children required patience, cultural sensitivity, and active listening.
- **Knowledge Gained:** Legal frameworks for child protection, government mechanisms for missing children, challenges in rehabilitation of children using drugs.
- **Soft Skills:** Communication, empathy, adaptability, and teamwork.

5. Challenges Faced

- **Data Collection:** Incomplete or inconsistent information from families due to fear or distrust of outsiders.
- **Authorities:** Limited cooperation from authorities in certain missing child cases
- **Language Barriers:** Overcame by adapting communication styles and using local terms.
- **Substance Abuse Cases:** Emotional challenges in dealing with children in crisis situations or affected by substance abuse.

6. Key Outcomes

- Filed multiple RTIs that contributed to SHAKSHAM database on missing children in North Delhi district.
- Assisted in awareness and community mobilization sessions in several localities.
- Provided educational support to children, improving engagement and attendance.
- Built trust in the community, enabling better access for SHAKSHAM staff in ongoing projects.

7. Conclusion & Reflection

This internship offered an immersive experience into the complexities, that allowing me to bridge academic learning with ground realities of child rights in India. From filing RTIs to interacting with children struggling with drug dependency, each task deepened my understanding of both the systemic and human dimensions of child protection. My time at CRY reinforced my commitment to advocating for vulnerable children and gave me practical skills to work effectively in this sector. I am grateful to CRY's team for their guidance and to the communities for their openness in sharing their realities.